

Business & Product Model

\$100B global study-abroad market problem, student persona lifecycle, lead monetization, and unit economics.

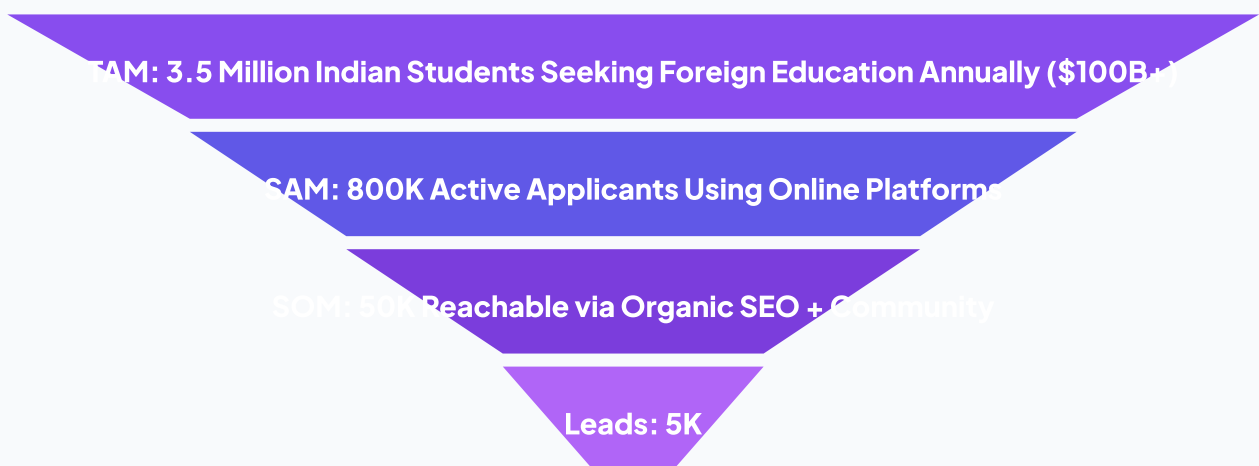
🌐 Market: \$100B+ Global Study Abroad

👤 Persona: Aspiring Overseas Student

💰 LTV: INR 15,000–80,000

1. The Market Problem & Opportunity Architecture

UNICOACH MARKET OPPORTUNITY FUNNEL



STUDENT LEAD LIFECYCLE — CRM PIPELINE STAGES



2. Technology Decision Framework

1. Lead Management System (Custom CRM vs Salesforce)

PRODUCT STRATEGY

WHAT IS IT?

A custom-built CRM pipeline in the Admin Portal that tracks every student lead from initial form submission through university enrollment.

HOW DOES IT WORK & PROBLEM SOLVED?

Instead of losing student inquiries in WhatsApp chats or spreadsheets, every form submission creates a tracked Lead document in MongoDB. Admins drag-and-drop across Kanban stages, AI auto-scores leads on eligibility, and automatic WhatsApp notifications keep students informed.

WHAT ALTERNATIVES EXISTED?

Salesforce CRM: \$150/user/month — prohibitive for an early-stage startup. **Google Sheets:** No automation, no status tracking, no AI scoring.

WHY DID WE CHOOSE THIS APPROACH?

Full domain ownership: custom lead statuses, AI scoring logic, direct WhatsApp integration, and zero SaaS dependency cost.

2. B2C vs B2B Revenue Model Decision

BUSINESS MODEL

WHAT IS IT?

UniCoach operates a B2C model — charging students directly for consultancy services — rather than a B2B model targeting universities for enrollment commissions.

HOW DOES IT WORK & PROBLEM SOLVED?

Students pay service fees (INR 15,000–80,000) for end-to-end university application support. Revenue is recognized at enrollment confirmation, not at lead acquisition.

WHAT ALTERNATIVES EXISTED?

B2B University Commission Model: Longer payment cycles (6–18 months), dependent on foreign university partnerships, subject to regulatory compliance across multiple countries.

WHY DID WE CHOOSE THIS APPROACH?

Faster cash conversion cycle, full control over pricing, and direct student relationship ownership.

💡 Senior Interview Defense: "Explain the UniCoach Business Model & Technical Strategy"

"UniCoach addresses a \$100B+ global study-abroad market with a technology-led B2C consultancy model. We built our own CRM pipeline rather than licensing Salesforce — giving us full control over the lead lifecycle, AI scoring integration, and direct WhatsApp automation. Our unit economics target an LTV of INR 15,000–80,000 per enrolled student with sub-30-day sales cycles enabled by automated AI qualification and real-time communication triggers."